

Teach political thinking. Without telling students what to think.

School-ready teacher handbook · Junior 12–13 and Youth 14–18

Candidate forms for controlled pilot use

QUICK START

A safe room for difficult ideas

Politangle School helps students identify values, concepts and trade-offs beneath political disagreement. It does not assign students to parties, reward a political position or expose individual answers to teachers.

The five-minute teacher brief

- Choose the age band before choosing an activity.
- Tell students: “I can see how the room answers, never who gave an answer.”
- BELIEVE items are perspective questions. They do not have a correct political answer.
- CLASSIFY and UNDERSTAND items test concepts and do have evidence-backed answers.
- Invite reasons without asking students to reveal their anonymous choice.
- Use distributions to start discussion; never call the average the “class ideology”.

Non-production boundary: Junior and Youth wording are candidate forms. Real-school use requires cognitive testing with intended students and qualified legal/privacy review.

Recommended first lesson

Ages 12–13: Who is trying to influence me? · 45 minutes

Ages 14–18: Where does our room stand? · 45 minutes

Choose the right route

Junior 12–13	Youth 14–18
16 concrete perspective questions Short social-media and power lessons No individual or class ideology label Best for first structured political discussion	Youth Quick 26 or Full 42 All 14 constructs THINK / FEEL / ACT in Full 42 Aggregate multidimensional and family-compatibility views

Activity menu

- Junior 16: a concise perspective activity for ages 12–13.
- Youth Quick 26: broad classroom map with manageable completion time.
- Youth Full 42: all constructs across THINK, FEEL and ACT.
- Political Literacy Quiz: CLASSIFY and UNDERSTAND concepts.
- Guided Lesson: a prepared goal, sequence, timeline and discussion path.
- Custom / single question: teacher-selected approved items.

Do not use Junior 16 as a diagnostic profile. It is a civic-discussion instrument with limited construct coverage.

Who is trying to influence me?

Learning purpose. Recognise emotional political messaging; separate claim, evidence, emotion and scapegoating; pause before sharing.

Run of lesson

- 0–8 · Compare two fictional social posts and mark reaction words.
- 8–22 · Run J10, J16 and selected literacy questions anonymously.
- 22–35 · Sort statements into claim, evidence, emotion and scapegoat.
- 35–45 · Use pause-check-compare; rewrite one manipulative post fairly.

Neutral discussion prompts

- Can an emotional message still be true?
- Why is blaming one group attractive?
- What would make a source trustworthy?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Power, fairness and disagreement

Learning purpose. Connect elections with limits on power; compare freedom, safety and fairness; describe both sides fairly.

Run of lesson

- 0–8 · Explain anonymity and the five-position scale.
- 8–28 · Run six Junior questions and pause on split results.
- 28–38 · Design a fair limit for a fictional student council.
- 38–45 · Private reflection: one view understood better.

Neutral discussion prompts

- When can safety justify limiting freedom?
- Why might a majority still need rules?
- Is equal treatment always fair?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Where does our room stand?

Learning purpose. Experience anonymous disagreement; identify competing values; separate a distribution from identity.

Run of lesson

- 0–5 · Join and explain privacy.
- 5–25 · Run seven cross-construct questions.
- 25–40 · Invite reasons, not party labels.
- 40–45 · Review and privately reflect.

Neutral discussion prompts

- What value is each side protecting?
- What fact could change an answer?
- Does a 50/50 room mean “centrist”?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Political families without stereotypes

Learning purpose. Distinguish five broad families; separate cross-cutting concepts; correct common misconceptions.

Run of lesson

- 0–10 · Introduce five families and cross-cutting concepts.
- 10–35 · Run CLASSIFY and reveal explanations.
- 35–50 · Run UNDERSTAND misconception items.
- 50–60 · Correct one misconception in students' own words.

Neutral discussion prompts

- Why is public healthcare not automatically socialism?
- Can nationalism join different economic ideologies?
- Which differences concern ownership?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Think, Feel, Act

Learning purpose. Distinguish judgement, emotional reaction and intended choice; treat tension as context, not hypocrisy.

Run of lesson

- 0–10 · Explain the three modes with a neutral example.
- 10–40 · Run four complete construct triplets.
- 40–55 · Discuss the largest aggregate tensions.
- 55–60 · Reinforce that ACT is stated intention.

Neutral discussion prompts

- When can principle and choice differ?
- Why is tension not hypocrisy?
- Which mode depends most on context?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Youth Quick 26 classroom lab

Learning purpose. Explore a multidimensional landscape; read distributions; locate consensus and division.

Run of lesson

- 0–8 · Explain privacy and the scale.
- 8–50 · Complete Youth Quick 26.
- 50–65 · Review map, compatibility and distributions.
- 65–75 · Discuss or continue privately.

Neutral discussion prompts

- Where does an average hide a split?
- Which dimensions appear independent?
- Why can several families fit?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Youth Full 42 profile lab

Learning purpose. Complete 14 constructs across three modes and use class-level tension as a discussion tool.

Run of lesson

- Session A · Join, Quick 26 and discussion.
- Session B · Remaining 16, mode comparison and map.
- Close · Discuss overlap without assigning a class label.

Neutral discussion prompts

- What changed between THINK, FEEL and ACT?
- Which results need more context?
- What does compatibility not prove?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Democracy, pluralism and populism

Learning purpose. Separate elections from liberal-democratic checks; distinguish populism from authoritarianism.

Run of lesson

- 0–10 · Introduce elections, checks and pluralism.
- 10–30 · Run pluralism and populism triplets.
- 30–45 · Run literacy questions and reveal explanations.
- 45–60 · Optional structured controversy.

Neutral discussion prompts

- Can populists support strong checks?
- Can authority preference exist without populism?
- Why can unelected institutions be both safeguard and tension?

Teacher close: Ask students to record one idea they now see as more complicated. Do not ask them to disclose their anonymous answer.

Neutrality is an active practice

- State the strongest fair reason on both sides.
- Do not praise a class for moving toward one pole.
- Do not treat majority agreement as factual correctness.
- Correct conceptual errors in literacy questions without correcting political preferences.
- Permit “unsure” and “it depends”; ask what missing information matters.
- Intervene when students target classmates or protected groups, while still examining the underlying claim.
- Never infer extremism from a single response, patriotism, welfare scepticism or law-and-order preference.

Four-question discussion routine

1. **Value:** What is each side trying to protect?
2. **Evidence:** What facts would help?
3. **Trade-off:** What might each choice cost?
4. **Revision:** What could reasonably change someone’s view?

The classroom privacy promise

The teacher sees joined counts, response totals and aggregate distributions. The classroom record does not provide a roster, student-to-answer mapping, individual political profile, individual family compatibility, individual THINK/FEEL/ACT result or individual literacy score.

Before students join

- Use the temporary room code or link.
- Do not ask students to put names in room labels or responses.
- Explain what the projector will display.
- Choose delayed reveal for sensitive questions.
- Provide an alternative participation route where required.
- Close the room and follow the school's approved retention procedure.

REQUIRES QUALIFIED LEGAL REVIEW before real school/minor deployment. The aggregate-only design reduces risk; it does not remove all legal duties concerning minors and political-opinion processing.

RESULTS

How to read the room

- Distribution first: two opposing clusters can produce a misleading middle average.
- Coverage matters: do not show family or axis results when too little relevant content was answered.
- Compatibility is not identity: several political families can fit the same room.
- THINK/FEEL/ACT tension is a conversation signal, not hypocrisy.
- Literacy accuracy can guide re-teaching because these questions have evidence-backed answers.
- Never compare classes as “more correct” politically.

Recommended report language

“This class distribution suggests...” · “Students prioritised several competing values...” · “The room was divided on...” · “The literacy result indicates that this concept may need another explanation...”

Junior 16 · candidate v1

Read each pair as two defensible directions. Students choose strongly first, somewhat first, between/depends, somewhat second, strongly second or unsure. This bank is for classroom discussion, not diagnosis.

J01	Government should make sure every family can get essential services such as healthcare and education.	Families should make more of their own arrangements, with government playing a smaller role.
J02	Taxes and public support should reduce very large gaps between rich and poor.	Government should interfere less with income differences, even when the gaps are large.
J03	Workers, cooperatives or the public should own more of very large companies.	Very large companies should normally remain owned mainly by private investors.
J04	School and public rules should change fairly soon when society's views change.	Long-standing rules should change slowly and only after broad agreement.

Junior 16 · questions 5–8

J05	People should be free to make private choices when those choices do not harm anyone else.	Some private choices may be restricted to protect important shared values.
J06	Authorities should limit freedom only when there is a clear risk of serious harm.	Authorities may limit some freedom early to prevent serious disorder.
J07	Even elected leaders must be checked by courts, laws, opposition parties and independent media.	Leaders who win an election should have wide freedom to carry out what voters chose.
J08	Countries should accept shared international rules when problems such as climate change cross borders.	Each country should keep the final say even when solving shared problems becomes harder.

Junior 16 · questions 9–12

J09	A person who becomes a citizen can belong just as fully as someone who was born a citizen.	Being born a citizen should count more when deciding who fully belongs.
J10	Politics usually contains several groups with real interests, not only good ordinary people against a bad elite.	Politics is often ordinary people against an elite that protects itself and ignores them.
J11	Protecting nature should sometimes come before economic growth.	Economic growth should normally come first while environmental damage is reduced in other ways.
J12	Religious beliefs should not be used to make laws for people who do not share them.	Religious beliefs can be fair reasons for laws even when not everyone shares them.

Junior 16 · questions 13–16

J13	National government should run important services when that gives everyone the same standard.	Local communities should run important services whenever they are able to do so.
J14	During a crisis, I worry more about leaders receiving too much power.	During a crisis, I worry more about leaders not having enough power to keep people safe.
J15	I feel more worried when elected leaders weaken courts, laws or independent media.	I feel more worried when courts or other institutions repeatedly block elected leaders.
J16	When politics goes badly, I first think about hard choices and groups wanting different things.	When politics goes badly, I first think an elite is ignoring ordinary people.

Youth Full 42 · candidate v1

All IDs and scoring coordinates align with the adult BELIEVE v2.1 bank, but the wording is a separate plain-language candidate form. Equivalence must be tested; the adult assessment remains unchanged.

public provision THINK	Government should make sure everyone can get essential services such as healthcare and education.	Government should have a smaller role, with people using more private choices for essential services.
public provision FEEL	I worry more when people may miss essential services because they cannot afford private options.	I worry more when government control of essential services reduces choice and independence.
public provision ACT	I would vote for government taking more responsibility to guarantee essential services.	I would vote for a smaller government role and more private responsibility for essential services.
redistribution THINK	Government should use taxes and support payments to reduce very large income gaps.	Government should interfere less with income differences, even when some gaps become very large.
redistribution FEEL	Very large income gaps concern me more than the higher taxes used to reduce them.	Higher taxes concern me more than very large income gaps.
redistribution ACT	I would support moderately higher taxes, including for me later, if they reduced very large income gaps.	I would choose lower taxes even if very large income gaps remained.

Youth Full 42 · items 7–12

ownership THINK	Workers, cooperatives or the public should own a larger share of big companies.	Big companies should normally remain mainly owned by private investors, with rules protecting workers.
ownership FEEL	It feels fairer when workers, cooperatives or the public own more of big companies.	It feels fairer when private investors keep most ownership, while laws protect workers.
ownership ACT	I would support policies that move more big-company ownership to workers, cooperatives or public funds.	I would keep most big-company ownership with private investors.
social change THINK	Public rules should change fairly soon when a new social norm gains strong support.	Long-standing rules should change only after a new social norm has broad and lasting support.
social change FEEL	I feel more uneasy when public rules fall behind a widely supported social change.	I feel more uneasy when long-standing rules change before society broadly accepts the change.
social change ACT	I would usually update an old rule once a new norm had strong, although not overwhelming, support.	I would usually keep the old rule until support for change was broad and lasting.

Youth Full 42 · items 13–18

personal autonomy THINK	Adults should normally be free to make private choices that do not directly harm other people.	Law may restrict some private adult choices to protect shared moral standards, even without direct harm.
personal autonomy FEEL	I am more uncomfortable when government restricts harmless private choices between adults.	I am more uncomfortable when law gives no weight to shared moral standards.
personal autonomy ACT	Even if I strongly disliked a private adult choice, I would oppose banning it when it harmed nobody else.	I could support banning a private adult choice if I believed it seriously damaged shared moral standards.
abortion THINK	Abortion should generally remain legal because the pregnant person should make the main decision.	Abortion should face stronger legal limits because prenatal life should receive greater protection.
abortion FEEL	I am more concerned about taking the decision away from the pregnant person.	I am more concerned about not protecting prenatal life.
abortion ACT	I would vote for broader legal access to abortion.	I would vote for stronger legal limits on abortion.

Youth Full 42 · items 19–24

authority order THINK	Government should restrict freedom only when it can show a clear and serious risk of harm.	Government may restrict some freedoms early when there is a believable risk of serious disorder.
authority order FEEL	During a crisis, I worry more about government using too much power.	During a crisis, I worry more about authorities lacking enough power to restore safety.
authority order ACT	During serious disorder, I would keep strong legal safeguards even if action became slower.	During serious disorder, I would allow wider temporary powers even if some safeguards were reduced.
pluralism THINK	Winning an election should not remove checks from courts, laws, opposition parties and independent media.	An elected government should have wide freedom to carry out its programme even when other institutions block it.
pluralism FEEL	I am more alarmed when an elected majority weakens independent checks on its power.	I am more alarmed when unelected institutions repeatedly block an elected government.
pluralism ACT	I would defend independent checks even when they slowed a government I strongly supported.	I could support reducing those checks if they repeatedly blocked the elected programme.

Youth Full 42 · items 25–30

world sovereignty THINK	Countries should accept binding international rules when shared problems cannot be solved alone.	Countries should keep the final national decision even when cooperation becomes less effective.
world sovereignty FEEL	I feel more uneasy when shared problems remain unsolved because countries refuse binding agreements.	I feel more uneasy when international agreements limit my country's final say.
world sovereignty ACT	I would support a necessary international agreement even if it limited some national choices.	I would keep national control even if the international response became less effective.
nationhood membership THINK	A naturalised citizen can belong to the nation just as fully as someone who was a citizen from birth.	Being a citizen from birth should carry extra weight in deciding who fully belongs to the nation.
nationhood membership FEEL	A naturalised citizen who takes part in the country's life feels just as fully part of the nation to me.	A citizen from birth feels more fully part of the nation to me than a naturalised citizen.
nationhood membership ACT	I would not prefer one equally suitable candidate only because they were a citizen from birth.	I would prefer the citizen from birth over an equally suitable naturalised citizen.

Youth Full 42 · items 31–36

populism THINK	Political disagreements usually involve several real interests and values, not only ordinary people against an elite.	Politics is often ordinary people against a self-serving elite that ignores their common interests.
populism FEEL	When politics fails, I am more likely to think difficult trade-offs and competing interests are responsible.	When politics fails, I am more likely to blame a self-serving elite that ignores ordinary people.
populism ACT	I would prefer a candidate who says political problems cannot usually be reduced to people versus elite.	I would prefer a candidate promising to take power back from an elite and carry out the people's common will.
ecology growth THINK	Environmental limits should sometimes come before economic growth, even if growth becomes slower.	Economic growth should normally come first, while environmental harm is reduced without deliberately slowing growth.
ecology growth FEEL	I worry more about environmental damage when growth is given priority.	I worry more about jobs and living standards when environmental limits are given priority.
ecology growth ACT	I would support firm environmental limits even if they moderately slowed economic growth.	I would reject limits designed to slow growth and choose environmental policies that protect growth.

Youth Full 42 · items 37–42

religion public role THINK	Religious principles should not be used as reasons for laws applying to people who do not share that religion.	Religious principles can be legitimate reasons for laws even when some citizens do not share the religion.
religion public role FEEL	I feel more uneasy when religious principles are used to justify laws for everyone.	I feel more uneasy when religious views are dismissed from public debate simply because they are religious.
religion public role ACT	I would prefer politicians not to use religious principles as reasons for laws applying to everyone.	I would accept politicians using religious principles as legitimate reasons for laws applying to everyone.
subsidiarity THINK	Higher-level government should handle important services when that best guarantees equal access and standards.	Important services should stay with the lowest level able to manage them, such as local communities.
subsidiarity FEEL	I feel more comfortable when higher government guarantees the same standards for everyone.	I feel more comfortable when capable families, communities or local institutions keep responsibility.
subsidiarity ACT	If both approaches could work, I would choose higher government to guarantee consistent standards.	If both approaches could work, I would keep responsibility at the lowest capable level.

What must be tested before launch

- Cognitive interviews: ask students to explain each side in their own words.
- Neutrality: check whether either side sounds kinder, smarter or more socially acceptable.
- Reading load: record skipped words, rereading and time per item.
- Construct match: confirm simplified wording still measures the intended political trade-off.
- Response behaviour: review “unsure”, missing answers and extreme-response patterns.
- Age differences: do not assume results from 16–18 year olds generalise to 12–13 year olds.
- Teacher usability: observe setup, pacing, projector reveal and debrief without coaching.
- Accessibility: keyboard, screen reader, contrast, zoom, motion and one-handed mobile use.
- Legal/privacy: qualified review of lawful basis, notices, minimisation, retention, vendors and student rights.

Automated structural tests are useful engineering evidence. They are not evidence that the questions are psychometrically validated or suitable for every student.

Before, during and after

Before class

- Select Junior or Youth deliberately.
- Check the lesson goal and sensitive content.
- Choose live or delayed projector reveal.
- Prepare a non-digital alternative.
- Explain anonymity and respectful discussion.

During class

- Watch joined and response counts, not individuals.
- Ask for reasons without asking who chose an answer.
- Show both sides fairly.
- Pause if discussion becomes personal.
- Distinguish preferences from literacy answers.

After class

- Close the room.
- Use only aggregate reporting.
- Record misconceptions and follow-up needs.
- Follow the approved retention/deletion process.
- Report safeguarding, privacy or technical incidents.

Politangle School · Teacher Handbook · candidate v1
Designed for controlled non-production evaluation.